State of the Web 2020–2025

HTTP Archive Trends in Page Weight, Protocols & Security

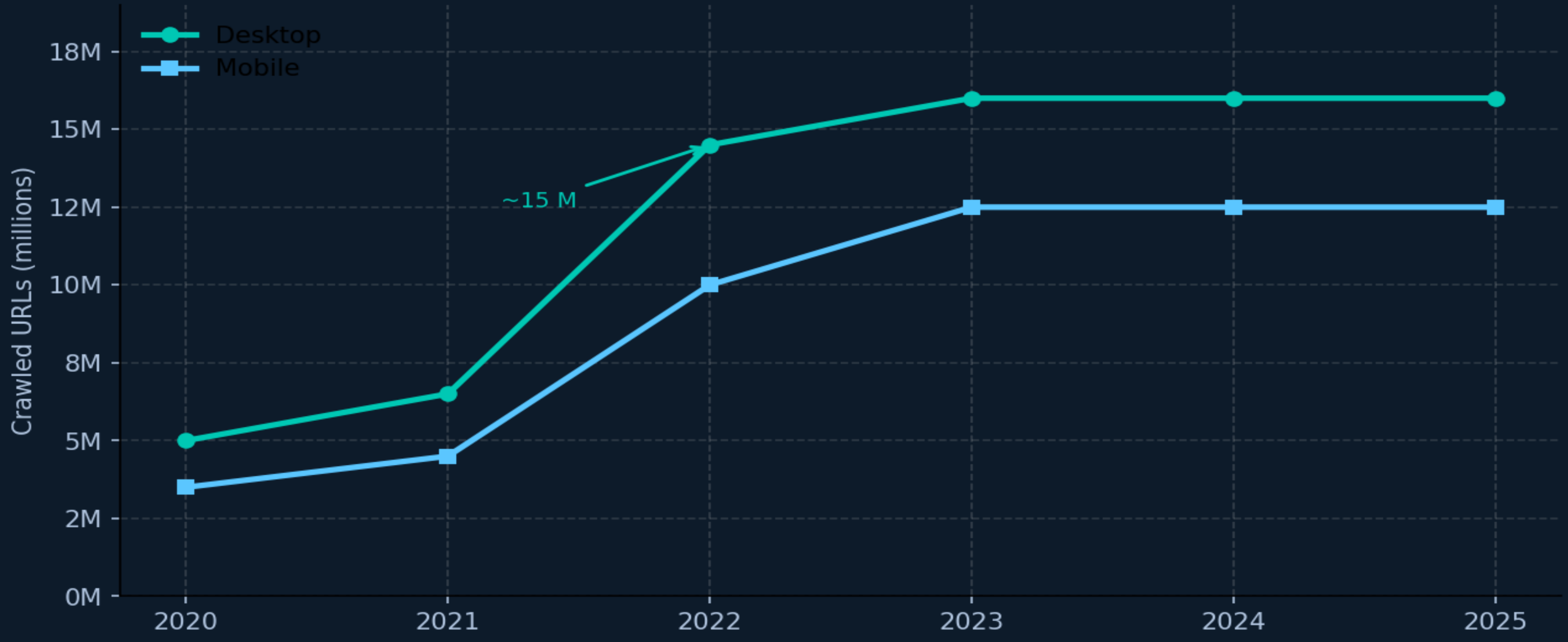
Source: HTTP Archive — State of the Web | Jan 2020 – Mar 2026

For web performance engineers and front-end architects

httparchive.org/reports/state-of-the-web

Crawl Sample Size Tripled: From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020

HTTP Archive desktop and mobile URL crawl counts over time (figure_1)



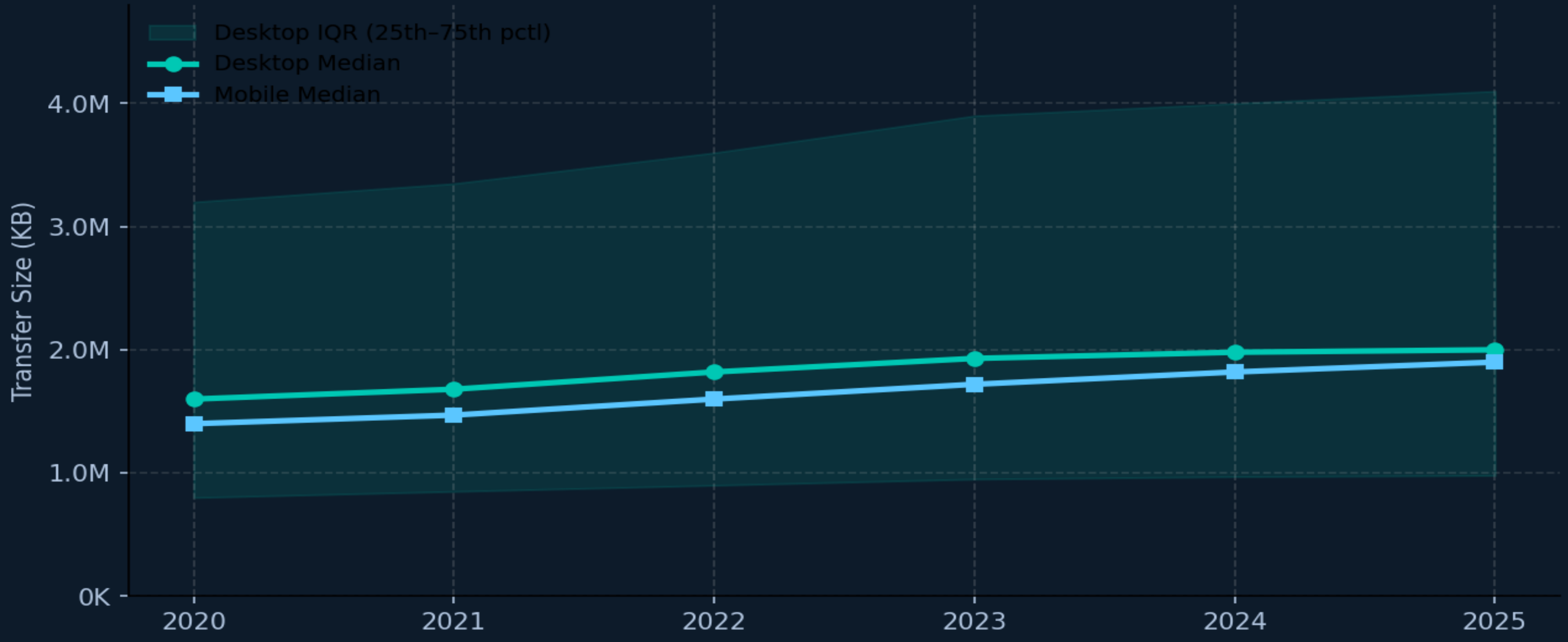
Source: HTTP Archive — figure_1

Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Deskt

+25%

desktop 2020→2025

Total kilobytes over time — desktop median, mobile median, and 25th–75th percentile IQR band (figure_2)



Source: HTTP Archive — figure_2

76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

Resource request counts rising but TCP connections declining — multiplexing efficiency gains (figure_3)

76

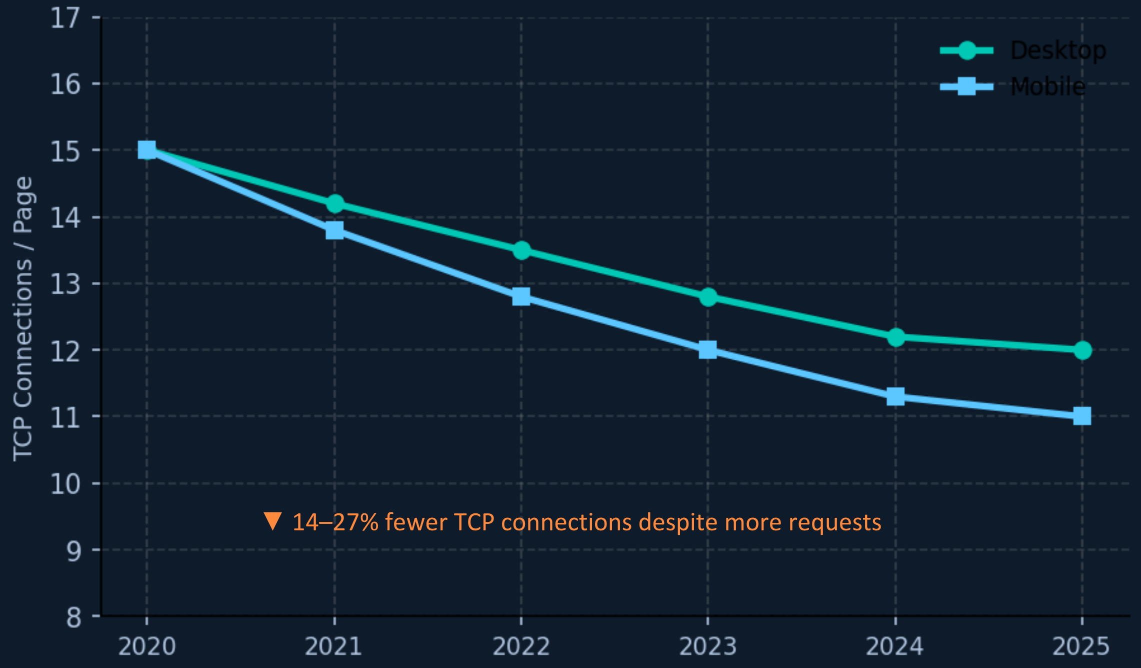
Desktop Requests / Page

▲ 2.7% since 2020

71

Mobile Requests / Page

▲ 2.9% since 2020



Source: HTTP Archive — figure_3

HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

HTTPS now dominates virtually all desktop and mobile requests — up ~19–20 percentage points since 2020

99.2%

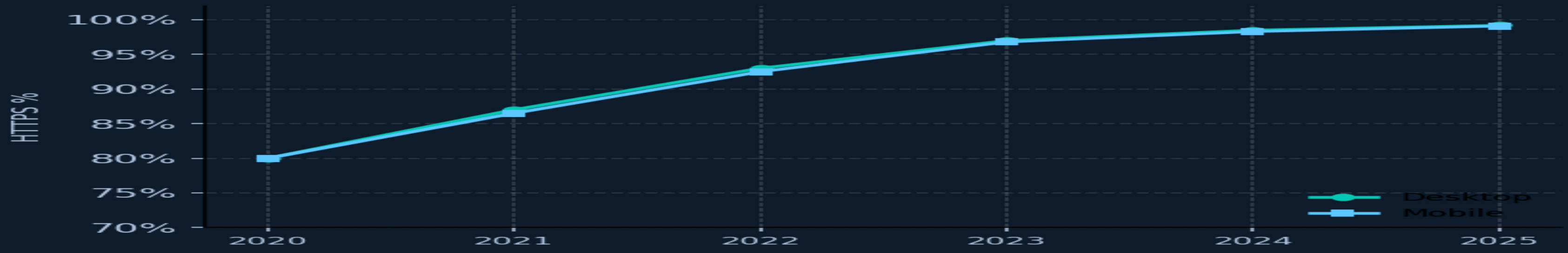
Desktop HTTPS Requests

▲ +19 pp vs 2020 (~80%)

99.1%

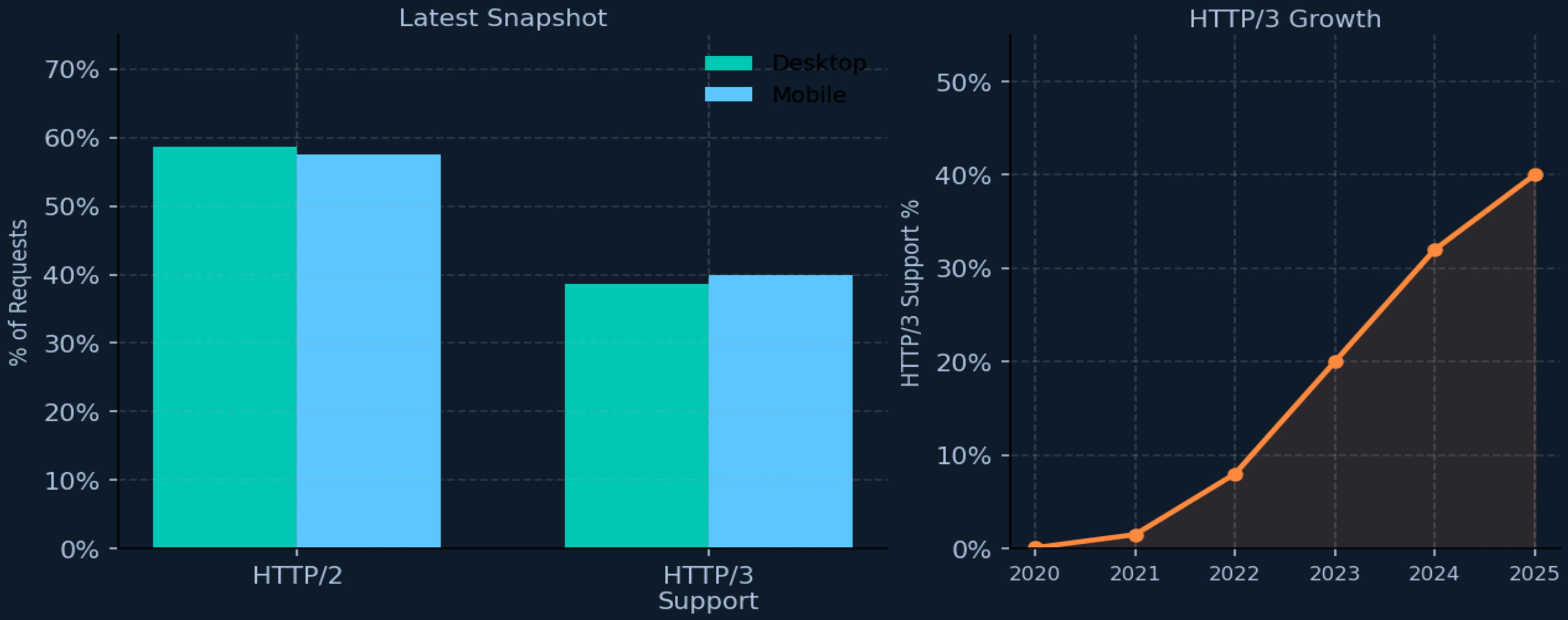
Mobile HTTPS Requests

▲ +19 pp vs 2020 (~80%)



HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%

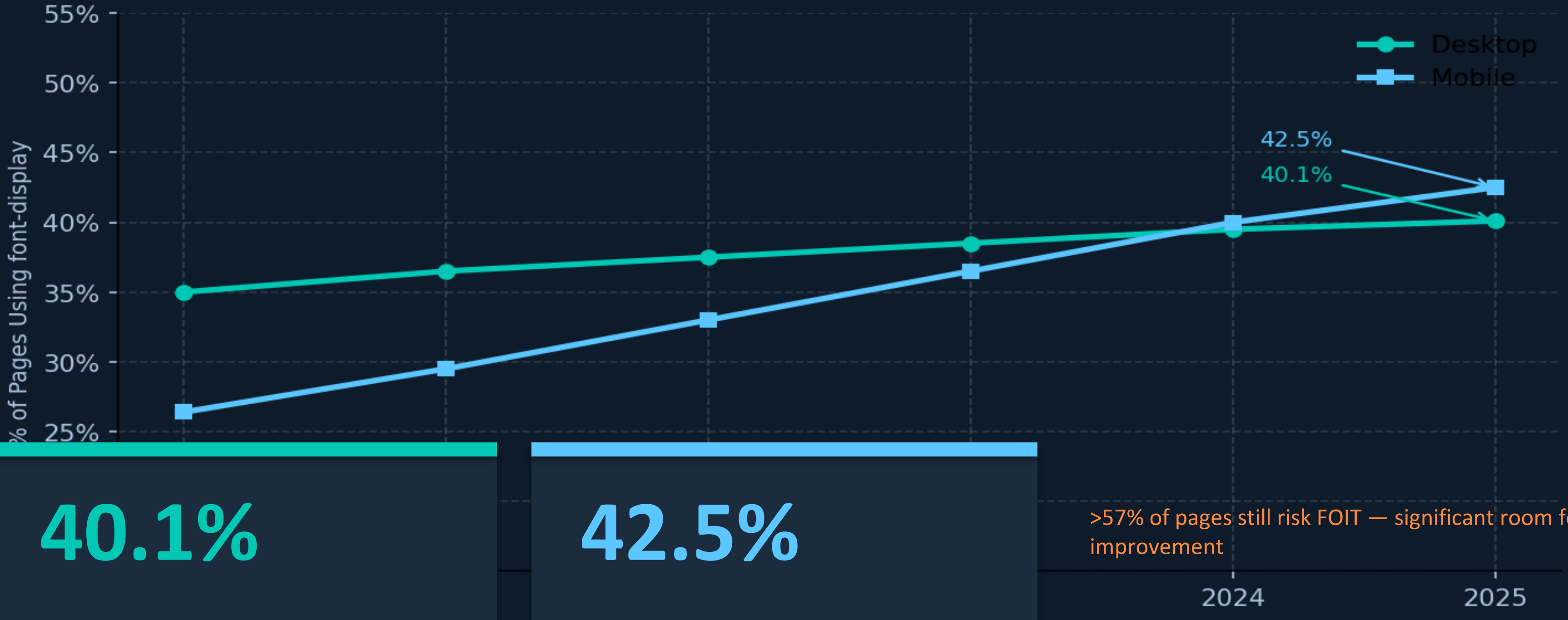
Protocol adoption snapshot and HTTP/3's rapid rise from near-zero



Note: HTTP Archive measures HTTP/3 support (fresh Chrome instances default to HTTP/2 before discovering HTTP/3 via Alt-Svc). Actual usage is higher in browsers that support HTTP/3 natively.

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020

Adoption of the font-display CSS property (Lighthouse measurement) — avoids Flash of Invisible Text



40.1%

Desktop Adoption

+14.9% since 2020

42.5%

Mobile Adoption

+61.0% since 2020

Key Takeaways: Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

1. **Page weight continues to grow at a moderate pace**

   Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB — ~25% heavier than 2020 — driven by richer media and JavaScript.

2. **HTTPS is effectively universal**

   At 99%+ of requests, unencrypted HTTP is essentially extinct on the modern web — a fundamental shift in baseline security.

3. **HTTP/3 is the fastest-growing protocol metric**

   From near-zero to ~40% support in under four years. HTTP/2 remains flat at ~58% as HTTP/3 absorbs new adoption.

4. **TCP connections are declining despite more requests**

   Multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 has cut median connections per page by 15–27%, improving network efficiency.

5. **Font-display still has significant room to grow**

   At ~40–42% adoption, more than half of pages risk invisible-text flash during font loading — an avoidable poor user experience.

Call to Action: Benchmark your own sites against these baselines using HTTP Archive's public dataset at httparchive.org